

Illustrative: a crude oil tanker off Port Arthur, Texas

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TRADE FLOW WEEKLY · WEEK 41 · 5 OCT – 11 OCT

Gulf oil flows rebound via the Red Sea bypass, but Hormuz pressure jumps and freight bites

302	32	6/9
trade-flow signals	critical	lanes active

THE BIG STORY

Gulf barrels are back, the tankers are not

- Saudi Arabia's East-West pipeline moved 5.8 million barrels as the Red Sea route recovers.
- Kpler: Middle East exports averaged about 16.5m bpd in September and suspects payments to Iran.
- Hormuz traffic is still well below normal, and supertanker rates hit $82 million.

BY THE NUMBERS

16.5m

bpd of Middle East crude and condensate exports in September, per Kpler

- Exports topped the pre-war 18 million bpd on several days
- Kuwait is back to about 2 MMbpd, 75% of prewar levels
- Standard Chartered: Hormuz traffic is still well below normal

LANE SCOREBOARD · THIS WEEK VS LAST



This week Last week

Strait of Hormuz	**63**	▲17
Panama Canal	**8**	▲4
Red Sea & Suez Canal	**7**	▼3
Mediterranean, Gibraltar & N. Europe	**5**	▲3

Red pins = critical signals · lines = lanes with signals · index = critical×3 + elevated×2 + watch×1

MARKET BY MARKET

Oil, gas & power 69

India's Russian crude imports fell to 310,000 bpd, driven by economics more than the US tariff threat, per OilPrice.com. Reliance pushed Venezuelan imports to a seven-year high. Russia's September seaborne crude exports rose 8% on the month to 4.088 million b/d despite sanctions.

Shipping & freight 146

Strait of Magellan traffic rose more than 70% year on year in August and September as ships avoided the drought-hit Panama Canal. A powerful earthquake left canal transits running normally. South Korea kept up its exports of clean products to Asia-Pacific.

Grains & agri 66

USDA raised its US corn and soybean crop estimates. Corn dropped and soybeans rose. Black Sea grain exports cratered amid a widening maritime war, and India-bound sunflower oil cargoes face cancellations. US farmers worry about Brazil's cost advantage for 2027 soybean exports.

Trade policy & sanctions 16

Ambassador Greer hosted G20 trade ministers in Milwaukee. Baltic nations are pushing for an EU ban on Russian grain exports. India notified a 5,841-tonne sugar export quota to the EU for 2026-27. Vietnam signalled it could ease its rare earth export ban.

WHAT TO WATCH NEXT WEEK

1

Hormuz

Will Qatar's empty LNG fleet start loading, and will traffic catch up with export volumes?

2

Saudi Red Sea coast

Will the reported Petro Rabigh incident be confirmed, and will it threaten the pipeline's export route?

3

Panama Canal

Will drought diversions via Magellan continue as the canal expands advance reservations for the 2027 dry season?

FULL REPORT

Lane scoreboard, every story and what it means for traders, charterers and buyers

worldtradepro.com/insights

Every signal is pinned on the live trade-flow map — updated each weekday.

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